

How to get better?

Tutoring, while lucrative, and easy to enter, is a market of mediocrity. It's far too easy to get into a rut with the same reliable students coming in week after week, to lose any motivation to be innovative or creative in your tutoring, and this is exactly what usually happens.

This is perhaps the most important bit of advice to a tutor - don't get in a rut. If you find that tutoring is a boring pastime for the weekends that's earning you a little extra spending money, you are probably a bad tutor. As someone providing alternative education to the next generation, a tutor is in a position of tremendous potential and influence. To use that to set the same old tests and to encourage the same old rote memorisation is criminal.

On the other hand, a good tutor searches for analogies and relatable ways to present concepts, is interested in and explores the psychology of learning, and is empathetic and receptive to feedback. To improve as a tutor is to improve your skills of reading people, presenting concepts, and evaluating performance - useful in any career. Gauging the level of comprehension that a student has, convincing her that the subject truly is interesting, grasping her attention and retaking it when it wavers, and helping her achieve milestones and get measurable improvements in performance - well, it begins to look like a pretty impressive set of abilities.

And if you're getting paid too, why not? 